

Waterfall



Summary:

A simplistic pixel art shaded waterfall particle system

Description:

The waterfall seems to function in local space and has it's velocity affected by gravity. If you watch closely it seems like there is a 2nd particle emitter at the bottom that shoots water droplets upward to give the impression of water droplets splashing around.

Use Case:

Great for beautiful backgrounds that don't take too much of the player's attention.

Effectiveness:

4/5

Relevance to game studio:

1/5 - could be used conservatively in improving visuals of backgrounds

Enemy attack telegraph



Summary:

A simpler particle system that launches red lines outward to grab the player's attention and to signal that the enemy is about to attack.

Description:

This is most likely done by using local space relative to the enemy who is attacking, and works by setting a constant velocity unaffected by gravity outward in a circle from the characters anchor point. Over the lifetime of the particle it fades out smoothly.

Use Case:

Proper particles for telegraphing an incoming attack is vital, and if done poorly could be too distracting.

Effectiveness:

5/5

Relevance to game studio:

5/5 - Telegraphing attacks is critical in any fighting games

Enemy attack trail



Summary:

The orbs flight trail is a perfect example of a good use of particle systems for information. As it flies and the trail exists a player can subconsciously extrapolate it's trajectory from the visible trail.

Description:

This particle system is a classic trail style system which works in world space and just leaves particles that dissipate after a short time. These particles don't have any velocity and are static to function as a trail properly.

Use Case:

Critical for any multi axis projectiles, or players may find these enemies extremely frustrating to deal with.

Effectiveness:

5/5

Relevance to game studio:

4/5 - We will most likely be creating a ranged enemy so trails will be important.

Enemy attack explosion



Summary:

The explosion of the orb that is launched at the player. Once again a very effective use of particles to convey information to the player, in this case we are effectively showing the range of the explosion as well as how quickly it falls off from the center, which is conveyed by the intensity.

Description:

The explosion is most likely done in world space originating from the anchor point of the orb when it explodes. I would hazard a guess that it is made up of quite a few components, as you can clearly see the energy pulsating from it initially when it lands, then the main spherical explosion and lastly the little shrapnel particles that shoot out.

Use Case:

This showcases effective use of visuals to convey timing, and lethality. This would be best used for any timer based weapons or explosions.

Effectiveness:

5/5

Relevance to game studio:

3/5 - Depending on if we have timer based weapons or projectiles concepts here could be utilized.

Lightning Whip



Summary:

This is a weapon that you can unlock that has a stun affect on enemies and creates a whip-like affect in a 2d space.

Description:

Most likely this is made by generating an endpoint for the whip to land at and then calculating multiple points above and below that point on the way in order to get a random lightning chain like effect, this is in world space as it does not move with the character.

Use Case:

This is a great example of how the visuals should change to match the item and how making things look cooler, can result in them feeling stronger.

Effectiveness:

3/5

Relevance to game studio:

1/5 - Our weapons should be very simple but if we have extra time to add variations, we may want to consider.